

Once to every soul and nation

*But the soul is still oracular; amid the market's din,
List the ominous stern whisper from the Delphic cave within,—
"They enslave their children's children who make compromise with sin"*

Text: James Russell Lowell, 1845

Music: Thomas John Williams, 1890

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The musical score is written for a single melodic line in 12/8 time, featuring a key signature of three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat). The melody is composed of eighth and quarter notes, with some measures containing beamed eighth notes. Chord symbols are placed above the staff at the beginning of each measure: Fm, C, D-flat, C, Fm, A-flat, E-flat, Fm, C7, Fm, Fm, C, D-flat, C, Fm, A-flat, E-flat, Fm, C7, Fm, A-flat, E-flat, Fm, C, Fm, E-flat, Fm, E-flat, A-flat, Fm, C, D-flat, C, Fm, A-flat, E-flat, Fm, C7, Fm.

1 Once to ev - 'ry soul and na - tion comes the mo - ment to de - cide,
2 New oc - ca - sions teach new du - ties, time makes an - cient good un - couth;
3 Though the cause of e - vil pros - per, yet 'tis truth a - lone is strong;
in the strife of truth with false - hood, for the good or e - vil side;
they must up - ward still and on - ward who would keep a - breast of truth.
though her por - tion be the scaf - fold, and up - on the throne be wrong.
Then to side with truth is no - ble, when we share her wretch - ed crust,
Lo, be - fore us gleam her camp - fires! We our - selves must pil - grims be,
Then it is the brave one choos - es, while the cow - ard stands a - side
ere her cause bring fame and prof - it, and 'tis prosp - 'rous to be just;
nor at - tempt the fu - ture's por - tal with the past's blood - rus - ted key.
till the mul - ti - tude make vir - tue of the faith they had de - nied.